

2026 MLB Draft Recap

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The MLB draft, in a lot of ways, is a scouts' World Series, a chance to lay out all the info and data they have compiled to make the best decision to put the organization in the best place to succeed. The 2026 edition featured some surprises, but the general top-40 prospects went in the first round. When diving into the following picks, I look at short-term club value alongside a player's long-term projection. I also look at an organization's history of developing similar players and at the other players available on the board when the selection was made. Some breakdowns will be deeper dives into a specific player, and others will be shorter breakdowns of multiple draft picks and how they fit into the organization's farm system. Breakdowns are not in any particular order. When WAR is used in my analysis, note it is referring to fWAR.

Part of my analysis used a self-developed consensus list of industry mock drafts to track recent movement, risers, and fallers. Analysis of draft day differences versus mocks is available after the player breakdowns.

ATLANTA BRAVES

AJ GRACIA (21 years old), 6'3", 195 LBS OF, VIRGINIA - ROUND #1, PICK #9

In the month leading up to the draft, AJ Gracia was one of the names gaining the most traction, making his selection by the Braves in the top 10 a notable move. A month before the draft, consensus industry rankings had Garcia being selected in the late 1st round, between picks 22 and 30. As the draft approached, Gracia continually moved up boards to be safely ranked within the top 15.

CARRYING TOOL

Gracia's carrying tool is his bat, which stands out due to his strong college production at both Duke and Virginia. In his 3 seasons in collegiate baseball, Gracia did not finish with an OPS below 1.000, and in each of his last 2 seasons, he walked more than he struck out. Gracia shows an advanced feel for the zone and good plate discipline (18.2% BB walk over 3 years), which adds to his consistency throughout his college career and provides a good floor at the next level.

SWING

At the plate, Gracia loads strongly into his back hip, slowly lifts his front leg, and rides it towards the pitcher for his stride. Gracia does dip his bat head, adding to a slightly longer bat path and a noticeable uppercut swing. Gracia is still able to show advanced barrel control in the zone, especially by getting to pitches at his knees. Gracia's bat path causes a high finish to his

swing, similar to Riley Greene's, and effectively drives the barrel through the baseball to add power. Gracia's swing shows clear power and torque to drive the baseball, and cleaning up his bat path should help him better protect himself against higher-velocity pitches up in the zone.

At 6'3" and 195 pounds, Gracia has room to add strength and to his power potential, especially if he slides to a corner outfield spot and prioritizes his bat. Gracia hit 49 home runs over 3 seasons and added 39 doubles. There is a chance the Braves can look at Gracia's launch angle and bat path to induce more carry on his batted balls, turning more of his doubles into home runs, especially with the Chop house in right field in Atlanta. Gaining a more consistent launch angle would also reduce Gracia's ability to pop up and get under the ball because of his uppercut swing. If Gracia can maintain a more controllable barrel and bat path, he will make more consistent contact on a higher percentage of in-zone pitches. If Gracia can continue to control the zone, take his walks, and develop his power potential, Gracia could be a very strong bat for the Braves for many years.

DEFENSE

Gracia does not show plus defensive traits, but as a college center fielder with good reads and route efficiency, Gracia should be a serviceable defender in a corner outfield spot. With a 45 arm, Gracia is better positioned for left field than right.

DEVELOPMENT PATH

Gracia fits the current mold of the Braves roster construction of recent years. Gracia is a bat-first outfielder who profiles better in left field due to his weaker arm. In recent years, the Braves have sought to fill their left-field position with similar bat-first profiles: think Eddie Rosario, Jarred Kelenic, and Mike Yastrzemski. Drafting a more polished P4 college bat like Gracia allows the Braves to fill their left-field hole on a quick timeline. The Braves should work with Gracia to improve his attack angle and bat plane to achieve a higher launch angle and generate more pullside power. The Chop House at Truist Field has a 315-foot right-field fence, and Gracia could see a power advantage from more lift in his swing to take advantage of the ballpark.

BALTIMORE ORIOLES

ERIC BOOTH JR., 6'0", 207 LBS OF, OAK GROVE (MS) - ROUND #1, PICK #7

Eric Booth Jr. has been comfortably a top-10 pick leading up to July 11th, with many mocks projecting him in the top 5. When he fell to the Orioles at 7, I am sure they were ecstatic at the opportunity to add a plus runner with a strong hit tool to their outfield prospects.

CARRYING TOOL

Booth's carrying tool is his speed. Booth has flashed 60 times between 6.27 and 6.33, and if he can continue improving his baserunning, his speed will translate into game-wrecking speed. Booth has also shown a strong ability to barrel the ball, with some of the highest EVs in the 2026 high school class. According to PG, the average exit velocity was 79 mph, with Booth topping 91 mph. Booth has MLB bloodlines, with Eric Booth Sr. being drafted in the 34th round in 1993. Booth has already shown a strong ability to improve his game, as pre-draft work highlighted improvements in his swing and defense over the year (cite). Booth should continue to display a strong work ethic and improve his hit and speed tools to move up the Orioles prospect rankings.

SWING

The biggest concern in Booth's game is his swing mechanics, but video shows that some issues can be cleaned up over time, especially given his age. Booth displays a medium leg lift to get into his back leg, showing good coil and power retention. During Booth's stride, he tends to drift forward, losing some of the power he holds in his backside. Booth has quiet hands through his swing, but corks the barrel upward to keep the knob of the bat straight down towards the plate. This occasionally causes Booth to cast his arms out to bring his barrel up to his hands, resulting in a longer swing. This also causes his bat path to flatten out, reducing launch angle and carry, and diminishing the power of his finish. So far, Booth has used his advanced hit tool and athleticism to overcome this hole against lower HS competition, but could be susceptible to velocity up in the zone. The Orioles should focus on Booth keeping his power loaded into his back leg more on his stride, and cleaning up his hands at the moment of swing decision. If Booth can keep his load back and have a more consistent bat path, generating a bit more power and launch angle, he can fully tap into his advanced athleticism to deliver more power and results.

DEFENSE

With Booth's speed, strong upside, and defensive potential, the Orioles have a toolsy fielder who could be elite in center field. While his arm strength is nothing to fawn over, Booth should look to combine his plus speed with better route running and reads.

DEVELOPMENT PATH

At 18 years old, Booth's focus with the Orioles will be on developing his bat and growing his defensive skills. Booth shows some holes in his swing due to inconsistent hands and swing path, but the Orioles have shown a strong ability to develop bats through their system. Creating more consistency in his hands and barrel will allow Booth to tap into his athleticism and drive the ball more consistently towards the gaps. Booth can also target improving his arm strength to pair with his plus speed and range, but as a future CF, prioritize getting good reads and efficient routes. The Orioles have good outfield depth across MLB and MiLB: Colton Cowser is under team control through 2030; Heston Kjerstead and Dylan Beavers are currently in pre-arbitration; and 2023 first-round draft pick Enrique Bradfield is on the doorstep of promotion (ETA: 2026). Bradfield profiles as a plus defensive center fielder with 80-grade range and speed, but lacks the

same offensive potential as Booth. Booth should refine his swing to add power and consistency, enhance his natural athleticism, and allow Cowser, Taylor Ward, Bradfield, Kerstead, Beavers, and top organizational prospect Nate George (ETA 2027) to fill out their outfield positioning in the short term.

MIAMI MARLINS

JACOB LOMBARD (18 years), 6'3" 195 LBS SS, GULLIVER PREP (FL), ROUND #1, PICK

Miami got the steal of the draft at pick 14 with Jacob Lombard, a high-upside prep shortstop with MLB bloodlines. Lombard was projected as a top-5 pick, but swing-and-miss concerns caused him to fall to 14. I especially thought the Cardinals would have taken Lombard at 13, right before the Marlins, to try to pair Lombard with newly extended star JJ Weatherholt, but opted for Trevor Condon instead. This may be a move they regret.

CARRYING TOOL

Lombard's athleticism is his standout strength, translating into good speed on the basepaths, an advanced glove, and a promising bat. His high offensive upside and solid defensive floor at shortstop make him a well-rounded prospect. However, his swing-and-miss issues against tougher competition highlight a notable weakness that could impact his development and draft value.

SWING

Lombard has a slightly crouched stance with relaxed hands starting by his head. Lombard has a medium leg lift and slightly backs his hands towards the catcher as he strides. He displays quick hands, short to the ball, and a good ability to get to the inside pitch. Lombard drives off his back leg well and transfers it well into his locked front leg, showing good mechanics for his long-term power potential. Lombard may run into his swing-and-miss issues due to his tendency to tuck his hands too far into his body as he swings, which can cause issues on higher velocities up in the zone and on offspeed pitches away, as was evident on the showcase circuit. Bringing his hands into his body forces them to "push" out towards the pitcher, making his bat path less efficient and pulling off the ball. His hands can also cause him to pull off the ball more and swing uphill more, increasing his whiff potential. When he doesn't tuck his hands too far inside, he can extend his arms well and catch the ball on the barrel, displaying his great power and hitting tools.

DEFENSE

Lombard's above-average athleticism projects well for him long-term defensively. Lombard's 65 grade run does translate to the field and contributes to Lombard's great range at SS. Lombard has the defensive makeup to be one of the rangier shortstops in MLB. Lombard in

the field shows good upper-body control as he fields the ball, allowing for a smooth transfer to his glove. Lombard shows confidence with his glove and range and takes efficient attack routes to the ball to make accurate throws. His arm is the lowest-rated tool at 50, which is a bit concerning for SS on plays in the hole, but could also provide teams with defensive flexibility as an elite 2B defender if it becomes a long-term issue. At 18, if he continues to build arm strength, he can also profile well defensively at 3B.

DEVELOPMENT PATH

One reason I am so high on Lombaard is his selection by the Marlins into their development system. In recent years, the Marlins have shown great agility in developing offensive tools for their prospects. The Marlins have displayed the ability to tangibly improve offensive tools year to year. From 2025 to 2026, Xavier Edwards increased his BB% by 4.4% and decreased his K% by 2.3%, resulting in a 27-point increase in WRC+. Liam Hicks decreased his K% by 5.5%, lowered his whiff rate to the 99th percentile on Baseball Savant, and increased his squared-up rate to the 99th percentile as well. This year, Hicks has already more than doubled his 2025 home run total, increasing his WRC+ by 26 points.

With Lombard being a Florida shortstop and the availability of knowledge and advice from his former big-leaguer dad, George, and his current Yankees top-prospect brother, George Jr., Lombard should find comfort in the Marlins system and settle in to refine his hit tool and bat-to-ball skills. The swing-and-miss is a red flag, as we have seen low contact rates due to prospects struggling across MiLB levels. Lombard could make teams play quickly to let him fall to #14, given his unique power potential at shortstop.

KANSAS CITY ROYALS

ZION ROSE (21 years), 6'1", 200 LBS OF, LOUISVILLE - ROUND #1, PICK #6

Zion Rose was the first surprise pick of the first round, with previous mock drafts projecting him to be selected in the 20-30 range. Still, the Royals' bold choice reflects confidence in his potential to develop into a key contributor.

CARRYING TOOL

Rose's carrying tool is his bat (55 hit/power), and he shows advanced bat-to-ball skills thanks to his quick hands, which lead to higher exit velocities. At Louisville, the coaching staff recognized his athleticism and offensive potential and, to preserve his durability and maximize his offensive production, moved him to the outfield. Rose has a great ability to get the bat on the ball and limit strikeouts, as he had the same number of walks and strikeouts over his 3 seasons (69). Rose is also graded a 55 runner, and was 65/74 on stolen bases in college, showing advanced base-path knowledge and good instincts for reads and balls in the dirt. At the next

level, Rose can lean on his bat speed and quick hands to get the barrel to the ball and maximize his speed on the basepaths.

SWING

Rose has a slightly choppy swing that, with some improvements, can add power to turn into a strong bat with speed for the Royals in the outfield. Rose has a high up-and-down leg kick to start his swing, and shifts aggressively back onto his back hip before exploding out of it. After his leg kick, Rose does have some excess movement in his hands, raising up towards his helmet before his swing decision. His advanced bat-to-ball skills could hide this issue for now at Louisville, but could be exposed against better competition. Because his hands move up towards his helmet as he swings, Rose tends to rotate uphill (rather than at the pitcher) and pull off the pitch. This causes Rose to get on top of the ball more often than expected, which takes away from his strong EV potential. If Rose's timing is off, he also tends to roll his wrists over, producing weak contact on the ground due to this misaligned rotation. Rose should focus on quieting the setup of his hands and rotating more laterally at the pitcher to ensure he is pairing his power potential with a better launch angle and bat path. While there are concerns with his hands and swing, the quick-twitch bat and fast hands are evident in Rose. He may not have as polished a swing as other college bats taken in the top 20, but shows clear tools to drive the ball all over the field and find barrels.

DEFENSE

Rose is listed as an OF after moving from catcher his freshman year, and with a larger frame, projects long-term at a corner spot. Rose has a 50 arm and a 45-grade fielding tool and will most likely never be an above-average defender on either side. Rose has the speed to play a serviceable left or right fielder and has good range and an average arm.

DEVELOPMENT PATH

Rose projects as an offensive-minded speed-power corner bat, and should focus on tightening his swing mechanics and honing his swing decisions to advance quickly through the minors. As noted, Rose tends to get on top of the ball, and he can always expand the strike zone at times and chase. This may be a factor of Rose being confident enough to make contact with any pitch because his bat control is so solid. Rose will need to reduce his chase and approach at the plate to learn to adjust to higher-spin offspeed pitches and better-sequenced game plans. The Royals making Rose their first overall pick in the draft could mean they see his advanced bat-to-ball skills carrying over time as he grows into his power. With time and swing adjustments, making sure he rotates better and does not lunge out of his stance, Rose is an above-average athlete who should progress quickly through the Royals system due to his advanced bat-to-ball skills. If Rose is unable to continue his bat-to-ball skills in MiLB and make consistent barrel contact, Rose could struggle to find his footing.

SACRAMENTO ATHLETICS

DREW BURRESS (21 years), 5'9" 185 LBS OF, GEORGIA TECH - ROUND #1, PICK #8

MASON EDWARDS (20 years), 6'2" 210 LBS LHP, USC - ROUND #2, PICK #47

The Athletics, over recent years, have built a strong lineup to take advantage of their offense-minded park in Sacramento and their eventual move to Las Vegas. The Athletics have struggled to get steady pitching at the big-league level, with Gage Jump and JT Ginn the only starters to post above 1 WAR this year (1.1 and 1.0, respectively). Their first two selections in this year's draft support their recent trend of college-ready bats to support the big-league lineup and a proven college arm that can move up the system quickly, given they smooth out a couple of inconsistencies.

CARRYING TOOLS

Burress shows an advanced hit tool to drive the ball extremely well from the right side. Even at only 5'9", Burress shows prodigious power at Georgia Tech and was a consistent producer in their lineup over his 3 seasons. His power plays to all fields, but Burress has great pull-side power to really drive the ball when he gets his hands through.

Edwards is an LHP with a good feel for his offspeed pitches, which keep hitters off-balance. Edwards has a 60-grade curveball and a 55-grade changeup to top off his repertoire. Edwards has a 50-grade fastball and control; Edwards's control improved each year at USC. His K%-BB% increased each year, from 18.7% in 2024, to 26.0% in 2025, to a whopping 30.8% in 2026. His fastball sat at 91-92 but could reach 95 when needed.

SWING

Burress starts with an open stance before having a high leg kick to finish closed to the pitcher. Burress has quick hands; at 5'9", he can really get to the ball inside due to his shorter arms and compact swing. Burress tends to have an inconsistent foot plant, sometimes opening up and pulling off the ball more. However, Burress makes up for this with good bat-to-ball skills. When Burress lifts the ball, he leans into his backside to get more lift and drive off his back leg. His swing allows him to get to pitches on the outer half of the plate, but if his timing is off and he falls into a pattern of pulling out of his swing, he could produce more weak contact against well-executed pitches on the outer half.

DEFENSE

Burress is a strong enough athlete to provide future versatility in both center and right field. Burress has good speed and reads to be a good center fielder, but also shows better arm strength (60 grade) to fit in right field. Right field may be the better fit in the short term with the

Athletics, with elite defender Henry Bolte in center and current right fielder Lawrence Butler struggling on both sides of the ball (67 WRC+, -8 OAA). Burress should be a quick riser, and I see Burress cracking the opening day roster in 2027.

DELIVERY

Edwards starts in hybrid stretch with his glove at his face. He has a quick tempo delivery, taking a step back with his front leg while sinking hard into his back leg. Edwards goes into a clean leg lift before sinking hard into his back hip and extending his hand far back behind his back, visible to hitters. Edwards then whips his arm into a high $\frac{3}{4}$ arm slot and hides the ball well from the hitters during his back-leg drive. Edwards has good direction over his front leg, finishing strong and rotating directly at the batter. Edwards displays very repeatable mechanics.

REPERTOIRE

Edwards is a 3-pitch starter, using plus slurve (60 grade) and changeup (55 grade) to set up his fastball (50 grade). His slurve is his best pitch, sitting around 80 mph with good spin to miss bats. His changeup is also effective against bats that miss, especially against RHH. His fastball shows good potential to become more effective at the next level. Currently, Edwards sits 91-93 and can reach back for 95, but his fastball has shown above-average effectiveness with a 30% swing-strike rate in 2025. This is most likely due to his above-average IVB, which was around 20 inches in his last season at USC. At 6'2" and 210 pounds, Edwards has room to add strength to gain fastball velocity and have his fastball play up even more with his offspeed pitches.

DEVELOPMENT PATHS

Both Burress and Edwards are players that should progress quickly through the Athletics system as experienced college prospects. Burress should refine his swing mechanics to reduce his tendency to pull off the ball better to get his barrel to all areas of the plate. Edwards should add strength to enhance his already effective fastball and continue working on effective sequences and pitch tuning with his plus offspeed pitches. The Athletics are an exciting offensive team, but the combination of these two picks in the 2026 draft should only help their ascent in the competition.

COLORADO ROCKIES

TYLER BELL (21 years), 6'1" 190 LBS SS, KENTUCKY - ROUND #1, PICK #10
DANIEL JACKSON (21 years), 6'2" 200 LBS C, GEORGIA - ROUND #1, PICK #37
LOGAN REDDEMANN (21), 6'2" 185 LBS RHP, UCLA- ROUND 2, PICK #38

The Colorado Rockies have a unique problem that no other team has: playing at a high elevation that changes ball paths at a disproportionate rate compared to other climates in the US.

The Rockies recently hired Paul DePodesta as their President of Baseball Operations, and it will be up to one of the inspirations for *Moneyball* to solve this issue. The Rockies made very strong first-round selections in this draft to continue their rebuild.

CARRYING TOOLS

The Rockies' first-round pick was **Tyler Bell**, a SS from Kentucky. Bell is a plus athlete with 20-home-run potential from both sides as a switch-hitter. Bell also displays good athleticism on defense, able to stick at SS long-term or move around the infield to provide versatility.

The Rockies opted for another college bat with their next pick, **Daniel Jackson**, a C/OF from Georgia. Not surprisingly, Jackson, the 2026 SEC Triple Crown and Golden Spikes winner, has a strong power bat that does have some tendency to swing and miss. Jackson exploded in 026 and showed the power potential he can display from the right side as a catcher.

The Rockies finished out their first three picks with **Logan Reddemann**, RHP from UCLA. Reddemann's carrying tool is his good fastball/cutter combo and his ability to attack the zone with both. Reddemann has always displayed good control, from his first two seasons at UCSD and this year at UCLA. Thanks to Reddemann's development at UCLA, he has his fastball up to 95-96, even hitting 99, and has added a hard cutter at 87-91 that he has shown to be effective on both sides of the plate.

SWINGS

Bell, from the left side, slightly crouched with the bat hanging over his shoulder, starts with a small leg lift and, while doing so, gets his bat into a good position, with the knob directly facing the catcher. Bell uses his small leg lift well, loading into his back leg and planting hard with his front foot. At his plant, Bell rotates quickly and maintains good separation between his hips and upper body to generate power. Bell has good balance in his swing and locks his front leg hard, showing a good transfer of power from his backside. The ability to separate his hips from his upper body shows Bell's potential to develop greater power. Sometimes, his quick hands will cause the barrel to be late in the zone, or have him more on his front leg. Bell can focus on improving his timing and bat path to ensure his bat whips through the zone on time.

From the right side, Bell starts slightly more upright in his stance. Bell also strides a little farther from the left side, along with a slightly higher bat path. Bell's swing mechanics are smoother from the left side, still giving him the platoon advantage overall. Bell should refine his right-side mechanics to more closely mimic his left side to become more consistent across splits. It will be interesting to see if Bell struggles out of the gate against lefties due to mechanical inconsistencies.

Jackson begins his swing with a top tap and produces good load into his back leg. Jackson keeps his hands still as he produces a small stride from his top tap. For his size, Jackson does have a small stride and rotates directly to the ball from a narrow stance. Jackson shows good extension and finish through his swing, but does tend to drop his bat head. This could be due to his narrow stance, which makes it harder to rotate and get his bat path to certain attack

angles. Jackson has shown a decent amount of swing-and-miss in his game. Despite his swing-and-miss, Jackson's strength and raw power are unquestioned, and he showed significant improvement in his barrel quality in 2026.

DEFENSE

As an above-average athlete, **Bell** has the tools to stick at SS long term. While he may never be an elite defensive SS, he can still play SS or all over the diamond for the Rockies. Bell has smooth hands on ground balls and quickly funnels the ball to his throwing hand. Bell shows a longer arm path on throws to first, not taking the ball directly to his ear, so it will be important for Bell to have good internal timing to track runners down the first base line and make on-time throws.

Jackson is an above-average catcher, displaying good framing skills and a strong arm behind the plate. As a blocker, there are areas of Jackson's game that need improvement, but as an above-average athlete, there should be a chance for him to improve and stick behind the plate long-term. If he is unable to be a proficient defensive catcher, Jackson also has experience in the corner outfield spots where his arm would be useful. Jackson displays a quick transfer behind the plate and good throwing mechanics while working towards second base. He is a high-effort thrower but shows strong accuracy with arm-side run to his throws.

DELIVERY

Reddemann starts by bringing his hands over his head, and overall has a quick tempo in his windup. Reddemann flashes a smooth high leg lift, then stretches his glove directly to the right-handed batter's box before tucking it firmly to his lat. Reddemann has a prototypical starter windup, hiding the ball well behind his backside before finishing with a high $\frac{3}{4}$ arm angle. Reddemann tends to show the ball behind his back more on his curveball and slider than on his fastball/cutter. It is not a huge tell, but could provide issues in the future if hitters can pick it up from the box. Reddemann also tends not to ride his back leg down the slope of the mound, opening his torso with his hips. This can reduce velocity and undermine command consistency.

REPERTOIRE

Reddeman has three good pitches to rely on: fastball, cutter, changeup. Reddeman also has a slider and curveball to mix in, but those are less polished at this point. Reddeman's fastball velocity ticked up this year, now sitting 95-96 and topping 99. His fastball showed 16-18 IVB and a good ability to miss bats. Reddeman has good arm speed on his changeup, sitting 85-85 to really throw off hitters' timing with the change in speed and tunnel. Reddeman's cutter has been a revelation for him this year, and he has shown the ability to attack both sides of the plate at 87-91. Reddemann's pitch profile features 3 pitches with distinct movement patterns, plus 2 additional offerings that could be plus-out pitches at the next level.

DEVELOPMENT PATHS

Bell's path is more straightforward than Jackson's and Reddemann's. As an above-average college switch-hitter with top-10 draft stock, Bell should focus on getting used to big-league pitching and refining his right-handed swing to be more consistent. This will allow Bell to address any timing issues that arise from higher-spin and higher-velo pitches. Defensively, Bell should focus on finding his defensive role going forward. The Rockies need to decide whether Ezquiel Tovar is the future at SS, but Bell should be the SS of the future given Tovar's struggles (.275 xWOBA, -0.9 WAR). If the Rockies opt to keep Tovar on the roster due to the financial commitment (signed a 7-year, \$63.5 million deal in 2024), they could use Bell's athleticism to slide him to 2B or 3B to get him at-bats.

It was not surprising to see the Rockies target **Jackson**, as he matches their recent draft trend to target players with plus power but questionable contact (think Ethan Holliday, Charlie Condon, Jordan Beck, Sterlin Thompson, Benny Montgomery, Zac Veen). The Rockies seem to be targeting these types of bats to play into the Coors Effect. If the Rockies can develop the hit tool of these types of players to at least league-average, their raw power potential should provide even more value, with the ballpark favoring exit velocities and launch angles. Jackson, therefore, should refine his swing mechanics, specifically his stride length, to achieve a more balanced swing to improve his contact rate. Jackson can also refine his approach to attack more pitches in his hot zones to try and take advantage of his raw power. This may come at the expense of his strikeout rate. Still, Jackson showed the ability to improve his K% and BB% from 2025 to 2026 without sacrificing his power at Georgia (29.7% to 20.1% and 12.8% to 13.8%, respectively), and should aim to continue that trend.

I liked the Rockies' selection of **Reddemann** because of his strong fastball-changeup combo. Coors Field has a significant impact on pitchers' individual pitch movements and on hitters' batted-ball data, specifically IVB and carry distance. Pitchers who rely on IVB for whiffs and chases, such as curveballs, sliders, and high-spin fastballs, often struggle at Coors because the altitude reduces the break on their pitches. Reddemann's fastball did not rely on spin rate for his high-whiff fastball, averaging between 2200 and 2400 RPM. His IVB and deception on his fastball come from his tall frame and deceptive arm action. With a plus arm-side changeup that pairs well with his fastball, Reddemann was a smart target for the Rockies. Reddemann has shown strong command throughout his years, and continued progression in that area will also allow him to limit damage on the corners of the zone. Reddemann needs to focus on enhancing his fastball/changeup/cutter combo to be especially foolproof against Coors' elevation, which has the highest Park Factor in the league at 113. As a college arm who also experienced arm fatigue towards the end of the year, Reddeman should be healthy before starting a throwing program to develop his repertoire further.

METHODOLOGY

Weighted Mock Draft Consensus

The goal of the weighted rankings is to clarify how industry experts evaluate prospects entering the 2026 draft, providing a framework for understanding their relative standing. These rankings are not intended to act as personal prospect rankings or a draft board. I combined mock drafts from MLB Pipeline, FanGraphs, ESPN, Perfect Game, Just Baseball Media, Sports Illustrated, Bleacher Report, Prospects1500, and Lookout Landing. I assigned weights to each mock draft source based on industry reputation, coverage history, scouting access, and analysis depth.

The final source weights were:

Jonathan Mayo, MLB Pipeline: 15%

Jim Callis, MLB Pipeline: 15%

Eric Longenhagen, FanGraphs: 12.5%

Kiley McDaniel, ESPN: 7.5%

Perfect Game: 7.5%

Just Baseball Media: 7.5%

Sports Illustrated: 10%

Bleacher Report: 10%

Prospects1500: 7.5%

Lookout Landing: 7.5%

Each player's weighted mock position was calculated by multiplying their spot in each mock draft by that source's assigned weight.

$$\text{Weighted Mock Position} = (\text{Mock Position}) \times (\text{Source Weight})$$

When a player did not appear within a source's first 40 selections, I assigned that player a value of 41.

Table 1. Final Weighted Mock Draft Rankings

Rank	Prospect	Weighted Position	MLB Pipeline (Mayo / Callis)	FanGraphs	Just Baseball
1	Roch Cholowsky	<i>1.175</i>	1 / 1	1	1
2	Grady Emerson	<i>1.975</i>	2 / 2	2	2
3	Vahn Lackey	<i>2.850</i>	3 / 3	3	3
4	Jackson Flora	<i>4.225</i>	4 / 4	4	4
5	Eric Booth Jr.	<i>5.950</i>	5 / 6	5	6
6	Drew Burress	<i>6.950</i>	8 / 7	7	5
7	Jacob Lombard	<i>8.875</i>	7 / 14	14	7
8	Derek Curiel	<i>10.075</i>	14 / 5	10	11
9	Ryder Helfrick	<i>10.575</i>	9 / 8	8	8
10	Tyler Bell	<i>12.250</i>	13 / 10	11	10
11	Chris Hacopian	<i>12.425</i>	19 / 11	9	14
12	Gio Rojas	<i>14.025</i>	6 / 21	21	9
13	Justin Lebron	<i>14.050</i>	11 / 12	17	17

14	Jared Grindlinger	<i>14.750</i>	16 / 16	6	13
15	AJ Gracia	<i>15.000</i>	10 / 9	16	21
16	Ace Reese	<i>15.700</i>	12 / 17	12	20
17	Trevor Condon	<i>16.000</i>	15 / 15	15	15
18	Liam Peterson	<i>17.675</i>	17 / 13	18	12
19	Cameron Flukey	<i>20.325</i>	18 / 19	19	—
20	Hunter Dietz	<i>23.625</i>	26 / 20	—	18
21	Zion Rose	<i>24.050</i>	25 / 23	13	22
22	Bo Lowrance	<i>24.200</i>	27 / 22	20	28
23	Carson Bolemon	<i>24.500</i>	21 / 29	26	19
24	Cade Townsend	<i>26.275</i>	24 / 26	25	26
25	Tegan Kuhns	<i>26.525</i>	20 / 24	24	24
26	Sawyer Strosnider	<i>27.575</i>	— / 18	29	27
27	Mason Edwards	<i>27.800</i>	38 / 36	31	16
28	Daniel Jackson	<i>28.650</i>	35 / 28	28	23
29	Cole Carlon	<i>28.725</i>	23 / 31	27	37

30	Logan Hughes	<i>30.750</i>	— / 25	23	32
31	Cole Prosek	<i>32.950</i>	33 / 33	—	25
32	Logan Reddemann	<i>33.825</i>	32 / 27	—	35
33	Taylor Rabe	<i>34.950</i>	40 / 39	40	30
34	Tyler Spangler	<i>35.200</i>	36 / —	36	—
35	Aiden Ruiz	<i>35.400</i>	22 / —	37	—
36	Brody Bumila	<i>36.000</i>	— / 30	—	—
37	Taj Marchand	<i>36.050</i>	31 / 32	—	33
38	Archer Horn	<i>36.725</i>	34 / —	—	29
39	Logan Schmidt	<i>37.050</i>	29 / —	—	38
40	Aiden Robbins	<i>37.250</i>	— / —	—	—

Month-Over-Month Mock Draft Movement

The month-over-month tables measured how each player's projected draft position changed during the final month before the draft. I only used outlets that published comparable earlier and final mocks. The paired sources were MLB Pipeline, Just Baseball, and Bleacher Report.

The comparisons were:

MLB Pipeline: June 4 compared with July 11

Just Baseball Media: June 9 compared with July 11

Bleacher Report: June 23 compared with July 10

FanGraphs was not included because its first complete 2026 mock was published only three days before its final mock draft.

The normalized weights were:

MLB Pipeline: 63.16%

Just Baseball: 21.05%

Bleacher Report: 15.79 %

$$\text{Weighted Movement} = (\text{Earlier Weighted Position}) - (\text{Final Weighted Position})$$

The current positions in the next two tables only use the three paired sources. They are separate from the 40-player weighted consensus ranking.

Table 2. Top 10 Month-Over-Month Risers

<i>Rank</i>	<i>Prospect</i>	<i>Earlier Weighted Position</i>	<i>Final Paired-Source Position</i>	<i>Weighted Rise</i>
1	Zion Rose	36.3	24.2	<i>12.1 picks</i>
2	AJ Gracia	22.6	13.1	<i>9.5 picks</i>
3	Logan Reddemann	39.4	30.7	<i>8.7 picks</i>
4	Logan Hughes	41.0	33.3	<i>7.7 picks</i>
5	Derek Curiel	16.5	9.7	<i>6.8 picks</i>
6	Taylor Rabe	38.6	34.4	<i>4.2 picks</i>
7	Tyler Bell	14.7	10.6	<i>4.1 picks</i>
8	Ace Reese	18.7	15.1	<i>3.6 picks</i>
9	Tyler Spangler	41.0	37.5	<i>3.5 picks</i>
10	Carson Bolemon	27.9	24.7	<i>3.2 picks</i>

Table 3. Top 10 Month-Over-Month Fallers

<i>Rank</i>	<i>Prospect</i>	<i>Earlier Weighted Position</i>	<i>Final Paired-Source Position</i>	<i>Weighted Fall</i>
1	Brody Bumila	19.4	37.5	<i>18.1 picks</i>
2	Aiden Robbins	28.2	37.4	<i>9.2 picks</i>
3	Cameron Flukey	13.1	22.2	<i>9.1 picks</i>
4	Sawyer Strosnider	18.1	26.4	<i>8.3 picks</i>
5	Archer Horn	28.8	36.3	<i>7.5 picks</i>
6	Caden Sorrell	33.4	40.5	<i>7.1 picks</i>
7	Chris Hacopian	8.3	14.6	<i>6.4 picks</i>
8	Jared Grindlinger	11.3	15.8	<i>4.5 picks</i>
9	Jacob Lombard	5.0	8.9	<i>3.9 picks</i>
10	Gavin Grahovac	37.8	41.0	<i>3.2 picks</i>

Actual Draft Risers and Fallers

The actual draft riser and faller tables compare each player's final weighted mock position with his actual selection.

$$\text{Draft Difference} = (\text{Actual Pick}) - (\text{Weighted Mock Position})$$

Table 4. Top 10 Draft Risers Compared with Weighted Consensus

<i>Rank</i>	<i>Prospect</i>	<i>Weighted Position</i>	<i>Actual Pick</i>	<i>Team</i>	<i>Selected Earlier By</i>
1	Zion Rose	24.050	6	Kansas City Royals	<i>18.050 picks</i>
2	Logan Hughes	30.750	17	Houston Astros	<i>13.750 picks</i>
3	AJ Gracia	15.000	9	Atlanta Braves	<i>6.000 picks</i>
4	Derek Curiel	10.075	5	Pittsburgh Pirates	<i>5.075 picks</i>
5	Taylor Rabe	34.950	30	Kansas City Royals	<i>4.950 picks</i>
6	Cade Townsend	26.275	23	Chicago Cubs	<i>3.275 picks</i>
7	Taj Marchand	36.050	33	Tampa Bay Rays	<i>3.050 picks</i>
8	Trevor Condon	16.000	13	St. Louis Cardinals	<i>3.000 picks</i>
9	Jared Grindlinger	14.750	12	Los Angeles Angels	<i>2.750 picks</i>
10	Tyler Bell	12.250	10	Colorado Rockies	<i>2.250 picks</i>

Table 5. Top 10 Draft Fallers Compared with Weighted Consensus

Rank	Prospect	Weighted Position	Actual Pick	Team	Selected Later By
1	Aiden Robbins	37.250	92	New York Mets	<i>54.750 picks</i>
2	Brody Bumila	36.000	89	Texas Rangers	<i>53.000 picks</i>
3	Sawyer Strosnider	27.575	66	Milwaukee Brewers	<i>38.425 picks</i>
4	Logan Schmidt	37.050	59	Cleveland Guardians	<i>21.950 picks</i>
5	Mason Edwards	27.800	47	Athletics	<i>19.200 picks</i>
6	Bo Lowrance	24.200	40	Los Angeles Dodgers	<i>15.800 picks</i>
7	Hunter Dietz	23.625	35	New York Yankees	<i>11.375 picks</i>
8	Cole Carlon	28.725	39	Toronto Blue Jays	<i>10.275 picks</i>
9	Aiden Ruiz	35.400	44	Pittsburgh Pirates	<i>8.600 picks</i>
10	Daniel Jackson	28.650	37	Colorado Rockies	<i>8.350 picks</i>

Top 10 Draft Day Differences from Weighted Consensus

Difference represents the absolute gap between each player's weighted mock position and actual selection.

<i>Rank</i>	<i>Prospect</i>	<i>Weighted Position</i>	<i>Actual Pick</i>	<i>Team</i>	<i>Difference</i>
1	Aiden Robbins	37.250	92	New York Mets	<i>54.750 picks</i>
2	Brody Bumila	36.000	89	Texas Rangers	<i>53.000 picks</i>
3	Sawyer Strosnider	27.575	66	Milwaukee Brewers	<i>38.425 picks</i>
4	Logan Schmidt	37.050	59	Cleveland Guardians	<i>21.950 picks</i>
5	Mason Edwards	27.800	47	Athletics	<i>19.200 picks</i>
6	Zion Rose	24.050	6	Kansas City Royals	<i>18.050 picks</i>
7	Bo Lowrance	24.200	40	Los Angeles Dodgers	<i>15.800 picks</i>
8	Logan Hughes	30.750	17	Houston Astros	<i>13.750 picks</i>
9	Hunter Dietz	23.625	35	New York Yankees	<i>11.375 picks</i>
10	Cole Carlon	28.725	39	Toronto Blue Jays	<i>10.275 picks</i>

Final Evaluation of Mock Drafts

This result highlights the limitations of using public mock drafts, which is important for the general public to understand. The weighted rankings provide a strong estimate of early selections but may overlook private team insights or draft-pool strategies. Acknowledging these constraints helps fans feel respected and aware of the scope of teams' draft decisions. Mock drafts can only use information available to the public. MLB teams have access to medical records, private workouts, interviews, background information, bonus demands, and player-development plans that are not always available to writers.

Mock drafts are also not completely unbiased, as multiple writers may hear the same team connection or draft rumor. If several publications repeat the same information, a weighted calculation may make the connection appear stronger, even if the original information came from a single source. For future versions, I would include each player's mock-draft inclusion rate, highest and lowest projected selections, and standard deviation. These steps will improve the accuracy of mock draft evaluations.

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